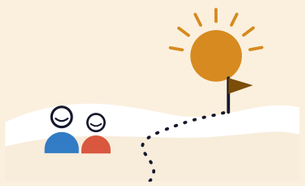
Form Your Team

# Our Team Canvas

Six conversations every team needs, in any order. Each one answers a few questions, and together they become your Team Canvas.



## 1 Why are we here?

### Our purpose

- Why do we exist?
- Who do we do this for, and how?

### Our future

- What does success look like in three years?
- How will we know it is becoming real?



## 2 Who are we?

### Our people

- What does each person bring?
- What do we want to develop?
- How do we each work at our best?



## 3 How do we work?

### Our rhythm

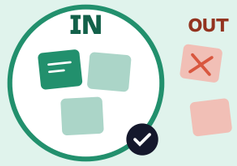
- When do we plan, make and review?
- What do we do together, and what on our own time?



## 4 How do we make decisions?

### Our decision making

- Which decision do we make often?
- Which way of deciding will we try?




## 5 How do we want to be together?

### Our team values

- What behaviour helps us do our best work?
- What behaviour is not acceptable?

IN OUT



## 6 How do we learn and reform?

### Our next evolution

- What will we keep, change and try?
- What would make us reset this canvas?



Exercises for every conversation at formyourteam.dk · © Michael Heider · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

1 Why are we here?

# Explain it to a friend

In pairs, explain why the team exists as if to a friend over dinner. The listener writes down phrases that feel clear and human, one per post-it.

Pairs · 25 min

## Words that felt clear and human

Put the post-its here, then group what keeps coming back.

## Our purpose

Use the strongest words.

**We exist to**

**for**

**so that**



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1 Why are we here?

# In three years' time...

Everyone writes two or three endings to the sentence, one per post-it. Group similar ones, then vote for the one that feels true, not just ambitious.

**Alone, then together · 30 min**

## In three years' time, this team will have...

Post-its here. Group them, then give everyone three dots to vote.

## Our picture of success

The one we chose, refined together.

## Signs it is becoming real

Two or three things we would notice.



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2 Who are we?

# Personal user manual

Everyone writes one post-it per question, with their initials, and sticks it in the right box. Then share in pairs: one question to understand, not to challenge.

**Alone, then pairs · 20 min**

## You get the best from me when...

## I struggle when...

## I prefer feedback that...

## Under pressure I may...

## Some of my quirks are...

## You can rely on me for...



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2 Who are we?

# Skills marketplace

Everyone writes three things they can offer and one they want to grow in, with their initials. Read them out, then pair people up.

**Alone, then together · 30 min**

## I can offer

Three post-its each.

## I want to grow in

One post-it each.

## Pairs to try

Who learns from whom in the next few weeks?

_____ ↔ _____ _____ ↔ _____ _____ ↔ _____ _____ ↔ _____



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3 How do we work?

# Draw your team’s loop

Put the meetings and habits you already have on the loop, one per post-it. Keep what helps, drop what doesn’t, and agree when each moment happens.

**Whole team · 30 min**

## Plan

When and how do we plan?

## Make

When and how do we make?

## Review

When and how do we review?

back to plan

## We drop

Meetings and habits that don’t help



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4 How do we make decisions?

# Choose how to decide

Write the decisions that keep coming back, one per post-it, and agree on one. Pick one of the twelve ways to make it, try it, then look back.

Whole team · 30 min

## Decisions we make again and again

Circle the one that matters most.

## Twelve ways to decide

### NARROW DOWN OPTIONS

- [ ] **Dot voting** A long list of ideas needs a shortlist, fast.
- [ ] **Multi-voting** One round of votes is too scattered to show a favourite.
- [ ] **Scoring matrix** Every option has its own trade-offs.

### DECIDE QUICKLY

- [ ] **Majority vote** There are two options and either would work.
- [ ] **Plurality** There are several options and no time for more rounds.
- [ ] **Authority** One person is accountable for the outcome.

### BRING EVERYONE ALONG

- [ ] **Fist to five** People seem to agree, but you can't tell if they really do.
- [ ] **Consensus** Everyone needs to support the decision to carry it out.
- [ ] **Consent** You need to move on, even if it isn't everyone's first choice.

### SETTLE WHO HAS THE FINAL SAY

- [ ] **Supermajority** A big decision needs more than a narrow win.
- [ ] **Unanimity** Every person must actively agree before you move.
- [ ] **Delegation** The whole team doesn't need to weigh in every time.

## We will try

This way, for this decision.

## How did it feel?

Keep it, or try another?



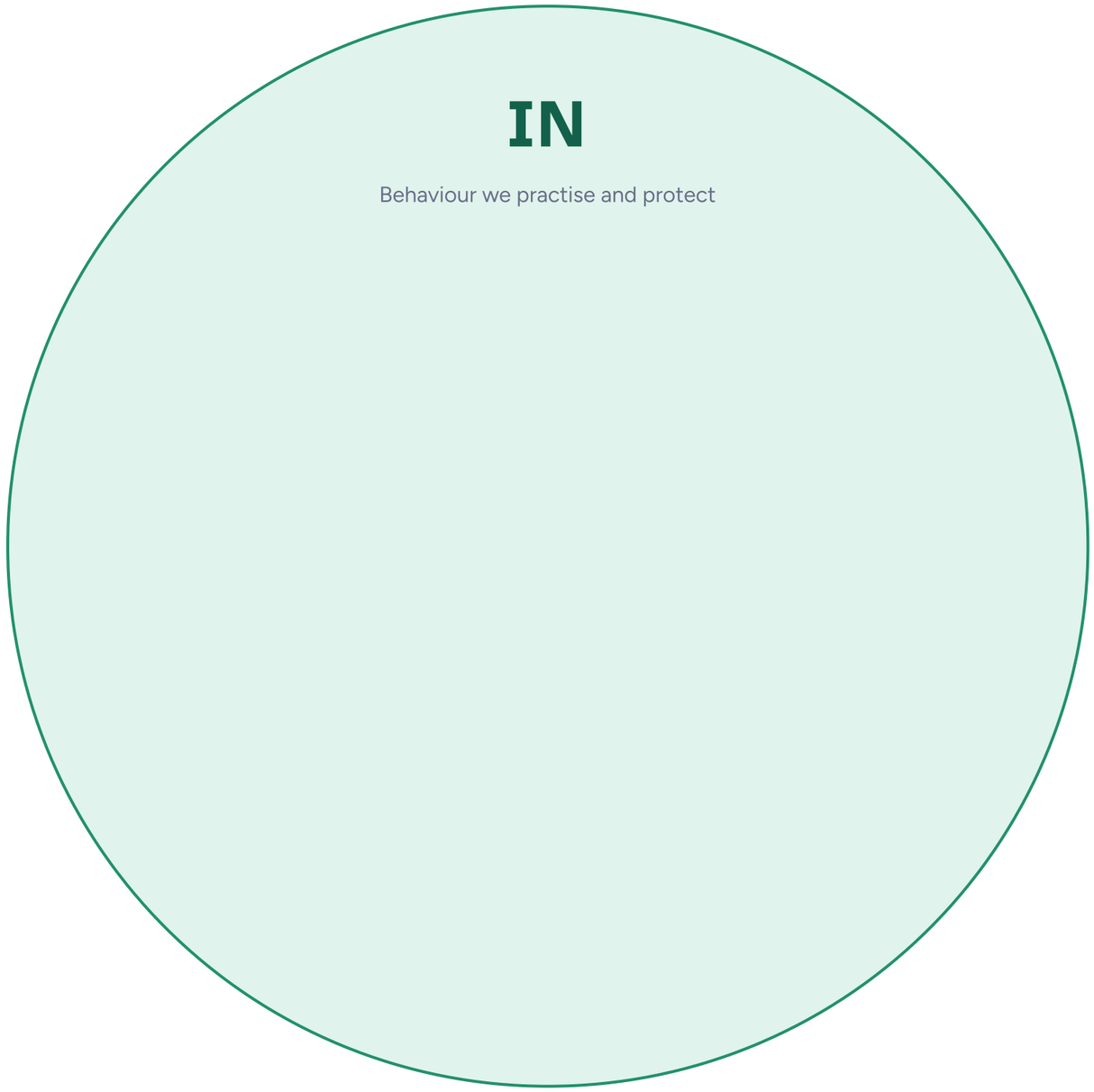
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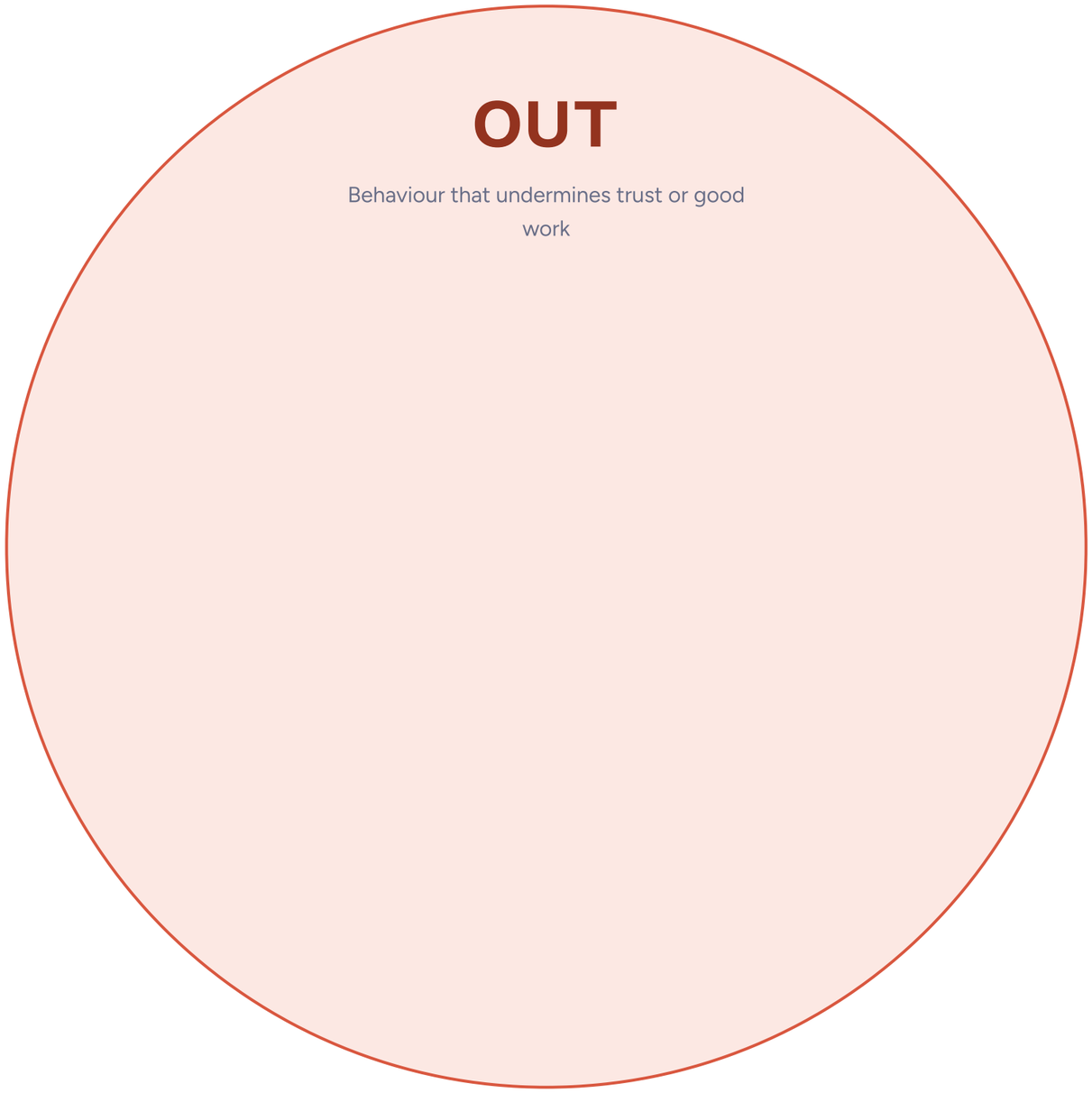
5 How do we want to be together?

# The two-circle team contract

One behaviour per post-it, written so anyone could see it. Stick it in IN or OUT, then combine similar ones.

Whole team · 45 min






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6 How do we learn and reform?

# Keep / Change / Try

One idea per post-it. Agree one small experiment, and what should make you sit down with the canvas again.

**Whole team · 30 min**

## Keep

What should we protect?

## Change

What is no longer helping us?

## Try

What small experiment will we run next?

## We sit down with the canvas again when...

For example: someone joins or leaves, or our purpose changes.



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